SAS SOLDIER'S KIT

When they developed their Counter Revolutionary Warfare capacity in the 1970s, the SAS adopted a range of clothing and weaponry suited to assaults on buildings or aircraft in which hostages were being held. In their assault on the Iranian Embassy in Prince's Gate, London, 1981, SAS soldiers used stun grenades and CS gas to disorient the hostage-takers. Their respirators enabled them to operate in the gas-filled environment. Most of the terrorists were killed by fire from the Heckler & Koch MP5s.

BALACLAVA

RESPIRATOR

Filters protect against chemical and biological attack

Headgear
The respirator, worn over the balaclava, provides protection against CS and CN gas and smoke. It also has anti-flash lenses, an internal microphone, and interfaces for oxygen and radio.

LEATHER GLOVES

Released safety lever

Location of safety pin (pin not shown)

Canister contained a volatile mix of mercury and magnesium powder

G60 stun grenade
Creating a blinding flash and 160 decibels of sound, the stun grenade, or "flash-bang", disorientates anyone within range. The one shown here was used during the Iranian embassy siege of 1980. Current versions also contain CS or CN tear gas.

Knife in sheath

Black suede combat vest

Bulletproof vest
Incorporating steel plates and padding, the bulletproof vest, or waistcoat, is designed to stop bullets and absorb their kinetic energy.